Kofi Ampoma Asuako, Ph.D.

Assistant Professor of Economics
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U.S. Work Authorization: H-1B Status

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a macroeconomist whose research lies at the intersection of macroeconomics and finance, with a focus on macro-financial stability, banking-sector resilience, and monetary policy design in emerging and developing economies. By combining structural modeling with empirical analysis, I investigate how fiscal-monetary interactions and financial intermediation shape business cycles, credit allocation, and systemic risk. Ultimately, my work aims to inform the design of coherent policy frameworks that strengthen macroeconomic stability and promote sustainable, inclusive growth.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2025-Present **Assistant Professor of Economics**
Allen University, Columbia, South Carolina

2023-2025 **Graduate Instructor**
Southern Illinois University Carbondale

2021-2023 **Teaching Assistant / Research Assistant**
Southern Illinois University Carbondale

2019-2021 **Graduate Instructor**
Eastern Illinois University

2017-2018 **Teaching & Research Assistant**
Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST)

EDUCATION

2021-2025 **Ph.D. in Economics**
Southern Illinois University Carbondale
Fields: Macroeconomics and Finance
Dissertation: Fiscal Dominance and Bank Fragility in Frontier Economies: Theory and Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa.

2019-2021 **M.A. in Economics**
Eastern Illinois University
Fields: International and Managerial Economics
Thesis: Trade Integration and Economic Growth in Africa: Lessons from SADC and ECOWAS.

2013-2017 **B.A. in Economics, Minor in History**
Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST)
Thesis: The Effect of External Debt on Economic Growth in Ghana: An Econometric Analysis.

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Macroeconomics; Financial Economics; Monetary Economics.
Secondary: Applied Macroeconometrics; Time-Series Forecasting.

PUBLICATIONS

Published *"Money-Financed Government Deficits and Bank Fragility in Frontier Economies."*
African Review of Economics & Finance, 18(1), 28-69 (2026).

Working Papers *"Structural Lending Bias: Credit Market Frictions or Financial Repression?"*
"Do Inflation Surprises Undermine Banking Sector Stability? Empirical Evidence from Ghana."
"Macroprudential Policy and Credit Cycles in Emerging Markets."

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2025-Present **Assistant Professor of Economics, Allen University**
Principles of Macroeconomics; Principles of Microeconomics; Personal Finance; Investment Management and Securities Valuation; Financial Statement Analysis; Risk Management and Insurance; Managerial Statistics (MBA); Quantitative Analysis (MBA).

2023-2025 **Graduate Instructor, Southern Illinois University Carbondale**

Introduction to Macroeconomics; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Financial Economics; History of Economic Systems.

2021-2023 **Teaching Assistant, Southern Illinois University Carbondale**

Introduction to Macroeconomics; Money and Banking; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Mathematical Economics.

2019-2021 **Graduate Instructor, Eastern Illinois University**

Principles of Macroeconomics; Principles of Microeconomics.

2017-2018 **Teaching & Research Assistant, KNUST**

Economic Statistics; Financial Economics; Advanced Macroeconomic Theory.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Principles of Macroeconomics; Principles of Microeconomics; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Advanced Macroeconomics; Monetary Economics; Financial Economics; Applied Econometrics; Time-Series Forecasting; Money and Banking; Quantitative Methods.

METHODS AND PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITY

Methods: DSGE; Bayesian and structural VARs; panel-data econometrics; applied macroeconometrics; time-series forecasting; nowcasting and mixed-frequency methods; scenario and risk analysis.

Software: Julia; Python; MATLAB; Stata; EViews; R.

Selected Presentations

2025

Missouri Valley Economic Association - Participant; AltFinance Workshop, The Wharton School - Participant; American Economic Association (ASSA) - Participant.

2024

Missouri Valley Economic Association - Presenter; Illinois Economic Association - Participant; American Economic Association (ASSA) - Participant.

2023

Illinois Economic Association - Presenter; American Economic Association (ASSA) - Participant.

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2019 **Credit Analyst**

Ejuraman Rural Bank, Ghana

Evaluated creditworthiness, monitored loan performance, and assessed credit-risk exposure.

2016 **Research Intern**

Ecobank Ghana Ltd., Ghana

Conducted market surveys and analyzed customer data to support strategic planning.

REFERENCES

Dr. Zsolt Becsi — Associate Professor; Dissertation Advisor
Southern Illinois University Carbondale | becsi@siu.edu | (618) 453-5067

Dr. Kevin Sylwester — Professor & Director, School of Analytics, Finance, and Economics
Southern Illinois University Carbondale | ksylwest@siu.edu | (618) 453-5075

Dr. Alison Watts — Professor of Economics
Southern Illinois University Carbondale | wattsa@siu.edu | (618) 453-5073

Dr. Scott Gilbert — Associate Professor of Economics
Southern Illinois University Carbondale | gilberts@siu.edu | (618) 453-5095